

Maxwell Francisco

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Education

University of Texas at Austin (Austin, TX)

August 2024 - Present

B.S. Environmental Science - Geographical Sciences

GPA: 3.7

- Relevant Coursework: Env GIS, Geoprocessing, Remote Sensing, Vegetation Ecology, Cartographic Design, Global Env Systems, Field Seminar in Env Science, Physical Geology

Appalachian State University (Boone, NC)

August 2023 - May 2024

B.S. Geography/Community and Regional Planning

Skills/Certificates

- ArcGIS Pro, Esri software, QGIS, Python programming/ArcPy, GPS, Environmental Fieldwork
- Esri Certificate in Cartography with ArcGIS Pro, Adobe Certified Professional in Illustrator

Experience

National Park Service - Tallgrass Prairie National Preserve (Strong City, KS)

May 2026 - August 2026

Natural Resource Management Assistant – Scientists in Parks Internship

- Conducted 301 vegetation transect surveys over 325 acres, identifying 11 invasive species, determining cover for 12 native shrub species.
- GIS and spatial analysis of shrub distributions across the preserve using stream, burn, and fenceline data.
- Presented survey and analysis results to NPS and The Nature Conservancy.
- Created an educational brochure given at the visitor center on native prairie shrubs.
- Assisted with a bumblebee bioblitz event, helping volunteers collect and ID.
- Worked collaboratively on a butterfly count survey, including species ID.
- Assessed long-term pollinator plant plot project success through survey and plant ID.
- Tick surveillance surveys using drag cloth, identifying and collecting ticks for disease testing.
- Photopoint quadrat surveys completed each month as part of a long-term documentation of landscape monitoring.
- Led Youth Conservation Corps members on plant ID and transect survey protocol.
- Invasive identification, removal, and assistance with herbicide application.

H-E-B (Austin, TX)

July 2022 - May 2026

In-Store Shopper

- Retrieved orders for curbside pickup at a large grocery store and delivered to customers.

Texas Classroom Teachers Association (Austin, TX)

June 2024 - September 2025

Intern

- Office tasks such as inputting form data, sending membership cards, and organizing payroll deposit checks.

Research

Digital Landscape Lab (Austin, TX)

September 2025 - Present

Undergraduate Research Assistant

- Analyzing ground site data and satellite imagery to evaluate the impact of fire on the landscape and woody encroachment in the Kalahari with ArcGIS and Python.
- Presented ongoing research at a university poster conference.

Andean Archaeology Lab (Austin, TX)

August 2025 - May 2026

Undergraduate Research Apprentice (URAP)

- Spatial analysis of the Inca site of Huánuco Pampa, including artifact distributions, and editing line drawing maps with Adobe Illustrator for a future publication.
- Presented poster at Undergraduate Research Apprenticeship Program conference.

Kalahari Science Institute – UT Faculty-led program (Ghanzi, Botswana)

July - August 2025

Student Field Researcher

- Measured shrub growth, including DBH, crown dimensions, height, and grass biomass as a part of a long-term study on fires impacts on woody vegetation in the Kalahari.
- Aided in spectral readings to assess usefulness of EMIT satellite sensor on measuring ground biomass.

Activities

Central Texas Model United Nations (Austin, TX)

August 2024 - December 2025

Senior Staff - Chair

- Led a small team of college staffers to host Middle/High School Model UN conferences.

Eagle Scout - BSA Troop 5 (Austin, TX)

2017 - 2023

- Eagle Project: Led restoration of a community garden at Camp Mabry used by guardsmen, veterans, and a PTSD counseling group.